Aileen C. Luo

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Updated October 2026

Areas of Research

AOS	History of Modern Philosophy (esp. Kant and his predecessors)
	History and Philosophy of Psychology (esp. learning and development)
	Philosophy of Cognitive Science and AI (esp. AI safety)
AOC	Post-Kantian European Philosophy; Philosophy of Mind; Philosophy of Law

Education

2027	**Stanford University**, Ph.D. in Philosophy (expected) Dissertation: "Genetic Epistemology in Kant's Psychological Philosophy" Committee: Allen Wood (co-advisor), Lanier Anderson (co-advisor), David Hills, Thomas Icard
	Stanford University, Ph.D. Minor in Psychology Certificate in Data Science
2017	**University of Oxford**, B.Phil. in Philosophy, *Distinction*
2015	**Tufts University**, M.A. in Philosophy
2012	**University of Hong Kong**, P.C.LL., *Postgraduate Certificate in Laws*
2010	**University of Cambridge**, LL.M.
2009	**City University of Hong Kong**, LL.B., *First Class Honours*

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Articles

2026 "Omissions, the Act Requirement, and Criminal Liability," *Criminal Law and Philosophy*

Manuscripts Under Review

Under Review "Sense and Sensibility: Kant on Berkeley on Spatial Representation"

- Winner of the 2025 Markus Herz Prize, North American Kant Society

Work in Progress

Drafted	"A Sense of Time: Kant on Locke on Temporal Representation"
Drafted	"Kant's Acquisition Theory of the Categories"
In progress	"Kant on Madness"
In progress	"Locke on Prejudice"
In progress	"Sophie de Grouchy on the Education of Affect"
In progress	"Agentic Affordance: Why LLMs Invite the Intentional Stance" (with Knut W. Gu)

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

2025	Markus Herz Prize, North American Kant Society (best graduate student paper)
2025	Society for Philosophy and Psychology Travel Award
2023	Patrick Suppes Dissertation Fellowship
2019	Full funding, Summer School on Neo-Kantian Philosophy, Chinese University of Hong Kong
2018	Thomas Mardenbro Benson Scholarship
2018	Language Study Grant ($10,000 for German language study in Berlin)
2013	Tufts University M.A. Scholarship
2006	Chung Hwa Travel Service Scholarship
2006	School of Law Legal Practice Manuals Prize
2005–06	Chan Tai Ho Scholarship (for best academic performance in cohort)
2005	HSBC Scholarship for Academic Excellence (for best academic performance across the university)

PRESENTATIONS

REFEREED

2026 "Agentic Affordance: Why LLMs Invite the Intentional Stance" (with Knut W. Gu)
6th International Conference on Philosophy of Mind: Artificial Intelligence, University of Porto

2025 "Sense and Sensibility: Kant on Berkeley on Spatial Representation"
North American Kant Society Midwest Study Group, University of Notre Dame

2025 "Recognizing Opportunities for Learning: Limitations of Predictive Processing from a Kantian Perspective"
Society for Philosophy and Psychology Annual Meeting, Cornell University

2023 "Grounding Kant's Categories"
Ethics and Politics, Ancient and Modern Workshop, Stanford University

2022 "Kant's *I think*"
Conference on Self and Embodiment, Trinity College Dublin

2019 "Cassirer and Kant on Perception"
13th International Kant Congress, Oslo

2018 "Omissions, the Act Requirement, and Criminal Liability"
Berkeley–Stanford–Davis Graduate Conference

2016 "Voluntariness, Duress, and Culpability"
Workshop on Knowledge, Reasons and Action, Erlangen University

2016 "Space and Apperception in the B-Deduction"
2nd Kant in Asia International Conference, Hong Kong Baptist University

DEPARTMENTAL

2025 "Sense and Sensibility: Kant on Berkeley on Spatial Representation"
Graduate Workshop on Kant's Philosophy, UC Berkeley

2024 "Kant's Acquisition Theory of the Categories"
Graduate Student Workshop, Stanford University

2024 "Kant's Acquisition Theory of the Categories"
Kant Studies Workshop, Stanford University

2022 "Leibniz and Kant on the Human Mind"
Kant Retreat, Stanford University

2022 "Kant's *I think*"
Kant Studies Workshop, Stanford University

2021 "Kant's *I think*"
Graduate Student Workshop, Stanford University

2016 "Space and Apperception in the B-Deduction"
Ockham Society, University of Oxford

Invited

2026 Discussant, *A Conference in Honour of Allen W. Wood and Rega Wood*
Department of Philosophy, Stanford University

Comments

2025 Comments on Timothy Butzer, "Autism, Schizophrenia and Predictive Processing: Some Lessons for Perceptual Epistemology"
American Philosophical Association, Pacific Division

Teaching

Sole Instructor · Stanford University

2026 Other People's Minds

2023 Theories of Consciousness in Early Modern Philosophy

Guest Lecturer · Stanford University

2025 Kant's First Critique

Teaching Assistant · Stanford University

2026 Philosophy of Mind
2026 Introduction to Moral Philosophy (×2)
2025 Plato and Punishment
2025 Introduction to Moral Philosophy (×2)
2025 Introduction to Philosophy
2024 Introduction to Moral Philosophy
2024 Modern Philosophy
2023 Modern Philosophy
2022 Minds and Machines
2021 Modern Philosophy
2020 Mind, Matter, and Meaning
2019 Minds and Machines
2019 Modern Philosophy
2018 Mathematical Logic

Teaching Assistant · Tufts University

2014 Logic

Pedagogical Training

2022	Preparing for Faculty Careers Seminar, Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Education, Stanford University
2018–19	Teaching Methods Seminar, Department of Philosophy, Stanford University

Professional Service

2025	Referee, Society for Philosophy and Psychology (conference submissions)
	Referee, *Aggressive Behavior*
2022	Mentor, Philosophy Directed Reading Program, Stanford University
2021–22	Organizer, Kant Studies Workshop, Stanford University
2021–22	Organizer, Kant Reading Group, Stanford University
2019–20	Coordinator, Graduate Student Workshop, Stanford University

Languages and Skills

Languages	Mandarin, Cantonese, English, German (reading)
Programming	MATLAB, Python

Professional Affiliations

American Philosophical Association
North American Kant Society
Society for Philosophy and Psychology

References

Allen Wood
Professor Emeritus
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

David Hills
Associate Professor
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

Lanier Anderson
Professor
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

Greg Wong-Taylor (teaching)
Lecturer
Department of Philosophy
Stanford University

Dissertation Description

Title: "Genetic Epistemology in Kant's Psychological Philosophy"

Abstract: My dissertation examines how Kant understands human agency and its role in cognitive development. Against the widespread view that the forms of intuition and the categories are innate fixtures of the mind, I argue that Kant is an anti-nativist of a distinctive kind: space, time, and the categories are neither implanted by God nor preformed by nature, but produced by the mind's own activity. The dissertation proceeds through three studies, each pairing Kant with an interlocutor on one form of *a priori* cognition: Berkeley on space, Locke on time, and Leibniz on the categories. Together, these studies develop a *genetic* model of the *a priori*, which explains how a mind given only bare capacities comes to acquire even its most basic representations. On this view, the human mind is defined less by endowment than by the agency through which representations become its own.